

SECTION 15

July 1, 2026

The synthesis. What fourteen sections of evidence establish about a single date, a single transition, and a single population. What must happen between now and then. What this report has asked of the people who read it

This section makes no new evidentiary claims. Every factual assertion in Section 15 has been established in the fourteen preceding sections, with primary-source citation. Section 15 integrates those claims into the specific question this report was written to answer: what the July 1, 2026 ADAP transition means for the disabled Indigenous Albertan, and what Canadian federal, provincial, and Indigenous governance actors must do to prevent the harm it will produce.”

This is the closing section of the Indigenous Disability Report. It is written in five parts. Part 1 summarizes, in the most compressed form the evidence permits, what the fourteen preceding sections have established. Part 2 applies that established evidentiary framework to the specific July 1, 2026 ADAP transition. Part 3 identifies the harm the transition will produce if implemented as designed. Part 4 sets out the specific actions this report asks of federal, provincial, and Indigenous governance actors. Part 5 is the closing statement, in the author’s voice, as the covenant that opened this report requires.

Part 1: What fourteen sections of evidence have established

The Indigenous Disability Report has documented, across fourteen evidentiary sections, a single structural pattern: federal and provincial governments of Canada have, across multiple generations and multiple policy domains, produced and sustained conditions that disable Indigenous peoples at rates substantially higher than the non-Indigenous population, and have failed to deliver the remediation their own official frameworks direct. The documentation is not advocacy. It is the compilation of primary-source evidence that the federal and provincial governments themselves have issued, commissioned, agreed to, or been directed to implement by Canadian courts, Canadian Human Rights Tribunals, coroners’ inquests, federal commissions of inquiry, Supreme Court of Canada decisions, and UN human rights mechanisms.

The fourteen sections, in compressed summary

- Section 1 established the historical context: the residential schools, the Indian Hospitals, the Sixties Scoop, and the direct causal framing that TRC Call to Action 18 directs Canadian governments to formally acknowledge — that the current state of Indigenous health is a direct result of previous Canadian government policies.
- Section 2 established the 19-year mortality gap: First Nations life expectancy at birth in Alberta at 62.81 years, the non-Indigenous Alberta comparator at 81.88 years. The summary statistic of every documented failure in every section that follows.
- Section 3 established the jurisdictional fracture: the federal-provincial division by which Indigenous Albertans fall into administrative gaps that neither level of government accepts primary responsibility for, producing the Jordan's Principle pattern documented in Section 8 and the off-reserve care gap documented across Sections 4 through 11.
- Section 4 established the housing crisis: the structurally substandard on-reserve housing, the urban Indigenous homelessness overrepresentation, and the documented correlation between housing instability and the disability-producing conditions documented elsewhere in this report.
- Section 5 established contaminated land and the multigenerational body: the Alberta tar sands, the oil and gas industry's documented health impacts on downstream First Nations, and the epigenetic literature linking environmental toxic exposure to subsequent-generation disability rates.
- Section 6 established the water crisis: the boil-water advisories, the federal Bill C-61 First Nations Clean Water Act legislative framework, and Alberta's July 10, 2025 formal opposition to the federal framework on "competitiveness" grounds.
- Section 7 established the dual healthcare system: NIHB and AHS operating without coordination, the 650,000 Albertans without family physicians, the 887 to 164 decline in accepting primary care practices, the anti-Indigenous racism documented in Turpel-Lafond's In Plain Sight and Statistics Canada 2024 data.
- Section 8 established the Jordan's Principle failure: the Canadian Human Rights Tribunal 2016 order, Canada's sustained non-compliance, the 9.96 million approved products and services between July 2016 and July 2025, the February 2025 operational bulletin narrowing access, and the children this failure has killed.
- Section 9 established the child welfare pattern: the Alberta 72 percent Indigenous caseload, the 17-to-1 apprehension disparity, Bill C-92, the 22 Delegated First Nations Agencies, and the October 17, 2024 rejection by 267 First Nations chiefs of the \$47.8 billion FNCFS settlement.
- Section 10 established the justice system pattern: the 10.2-fold Indigenous adult incarceration overrepresentation, the 18.4-fold Indigenous women overrepresentation, R v Gladue (1999) and R v Ipeelee (2012), the UN Working Group on Arbitrary Detention August 4, 2025 "deeply concerned" finding, and the two-thirds of Indigenous federal inmates who have been in foster care.

- Section 11 established the MMIWG2S+ crisis: the 2019 National Inquiry's genocide finding, the 231 Calls for Justice, the two completed as of 2024, and the April 8, 2026 CBC report documenting federal funding sunset for the National Family and Survivors Circle and Giganawenimaanaanig.
- Section 12 established the UNDRIP and consultation failure: UNDRIP Articles 19, 21(1), 21(2), 23, and 32(2), the UNDA Act of June 21, 2021, the Kebaowek Federal Court 2025 decision, and the absence of Indigenous-specific consultation on the ADAP transition.
- Section 13 established the Sovereignty Act and Treaty confrontation: Bill 1 of 2022, Bill 54 of 2025, the Onion Lake Cree Nation litigation, the January 29, 2026 Edmonton press conference at which every Treaty confederacy in Alberta declared the provincial government has no constitutional authority to pursue independence without Indigenous consent.
- Section 14 established the TRC Calls to Action 18 through 24: the seven health Calls, the Yellowhead Institute's September 2025 characterization of Canadian implementation as "performative reconciliation," and the Statistics Canada 2024 documentation of 24 percent of off-reserve First Nations experiencing healthcare discrimination in the past year.

The pattern across fourteen sections

Taken together, the fourteen sections establish a pattern with the following documented characteristics:

- At every stage of the life course, Indigenous Albertans face documented structural conditions that produce, sustain, and compound disability. From in utero exposure to residential school-era trauma transmitted epigenetically, through childhood in the child welfare system, into adulthood in the justice system and into death an average of 19 years earlier than their non-Indigenous neighbours.
- At every structural level, the federal and provincial governments of Canada have accepted formal obligations — through Supreme Court decisions, UN Declarations, domestic implementation legislation, Human Rights Tribunal orders, federal commissions of inquiry, and Truth and Reconciliation Commission Calls to Action — to remediate these conditions.
- At every implementation stage, remediation has been partial, performative, or non-compliant. The gap between formal obligation and operational reality is the primary finding of this report.
- The documented population — the disabled Indigenous Albertan — exists at the intersection of each of these failures. Every section of this report describes a dimension of their life. The July 1, 2026 ADAP transition is the specific next chapter in this documented pattern.

Part 2: The July 1, 2026 ADAP transition in this context

What the transition will do

The Alberta Disability Assistance Program, scheduled to replace the Assured Income for the Severely Handicapped on July 1, 2026, will change the disability income framework for approximately 79,290 Albertans. The transition's elements, documented in the Alberta Disability System Breakdown main report series:

- Reassessment of eligibility under standardized criteria, including the ADAP Disability Assistance Medical Report required to be completed by a physician — the access to whom has collapsed from 887 accepting practices to 164 in Alberta.
- Removal of the independent appeal rights structure that has existed for AISH recipients since the program's creation, through Bill 12 passed December 9, 2025, with the Medical Review Panel decisions now final and unchallengeable.
- Dollar-for-dollar clawback of the federal Canada Disability Benefit, a provincial policy choice Alberta stands alone on among Canadian provinces in making.
- Reductions in benefit amounts for certain recipient categories and elimination of supplementary supports previously administered under PDD, FSCD, and related programs.
- The operational apparatus continues to coordinate the transition with the Alberta Justice Inmate Records system documented in Section 10 and the Children and Family Services apprehension pattern documented in Section 9.

What the Indigenous dimension of the transition means

Of the 79,290 affected Albertans, the Government of Alberta has not publicly disaggregated the proportion who are Indigenous. Every structural condition documented in Sections 1 through 14 — the 19-year mortality gap, the disproportionate disability incidence rooted in the causal factors the TRC Call to Action 18 identified, the child welfare pipeline, the incarceration pipeline, the MMIWG2S+ vulnerability cascade — establishes that the Indigenous share of the affected population is substantial, documented in its social and structural determinants, and that the transition will affect them with particular severity. The Alberta government's decision not to publicly disaggregate the Indigenous share of the AISH caseload is itself a documentation choice that obscures the specific impact this report has been written to name.

Applied to the population this report concerns, the ADAP transition operates as:

- A reduction in disability income for Indigenous Albertans whose disability profile is itself the product of the residential school, contaminated land, water, healthcare, and child welfare failures documented in Sections 1, 5, 6, 7, and 9.
- A removal of the administrative remedy by which those Indigenous Albertans could individually challenge specific eligibility decisions (Bill 12).
- A clawback of the federal Canada Disability Benefit the federal government designed to reduce disability poverty — reducing the one mechanism by which federal redress could have partially offset provincial failure.

- An implementation proceeding without the consultation UNDRIP Articles 19 and 21 require (Section 12), within the constitutional constraint Treaty 6, 7, and 8 chiefs have repeatedly articulated (Section 13), and in direct tension with TRC Calls to Action 18, 20, 21, 22, and 23 (Section 14).

Part 3: What will happen if the transition proceeds as designed

The cascade

The cascade of harm the ADAP transition will produce for disabled Indigenous Albertans, if implemented July 1, 2026 as currently designed, is documented across Sections 4, 7, 9, 10, and 11 of this report. Summarized:

- Reduction or revocation of AISH benefits under ADAP reassessment produces income loss for Indigenous Albertans whose incomes are already below the poverty line. The Alberta Disability System Breakdown main series destabilization cost modelling (Sorochan) documents provincial incarceration cost at \$60,000 to \$80,000 per person per year, against AISH support at \$20,772 per year.
- Income loss produces housing instability — for disabled Indigenous Albertans whose rent already exceeds the AISH benefit, any reduction in income produces eviction risk that intersects with the documented 10-year First Nations housing shortage and the homelessness overrepresentation Section 4 documented.
- Housing instability produces the MMIWG2S+ vulnerability cascade Section 11 documented: dependency on housing with potentially violent partners, reduced ability to leave violent situations, sustained exposure to violence. For Indigenous women specifically, this cascade is the documented pathway to the 12-fold disparity the 2019 National Inquiry characterized as genocide.
- Housing instability and income loss intersect with the child welfare pattern Section 9 documented: apprehension risk for the children of destabilized disabled Indigenous Albertans, feeding the 72 percent Indigenous Alberta caseload and the downstream pattern in which two-thirds of Indigenous federal inmates have been in foster care.
- The foster-care-to-prison pipeline Section 10 documented activates at scale across the affected children's life course, producing, at population level, subsequent cycles of the 10.2-fold incarceration overrepresentation.
- At every stage of the cascade, the documented administrative coordination of the Alberta Income Support, Alberta Justice Corrections, and Children and Family Services systems (Alberta IES Policy Manual SEIP 3850-1 AFSS Match documentation) operates to compound the destabilization rather than mitigate it.

The ADAP transition, implemented July 1, 2026 as currently designed, will operate at population scale to compound every documented pattern this report has established. The transition is not disability income policy in isolation. It is the specific next mechanism by which the documented pattern continues.”

The fiscal arithmetic

The fiscal arithmetic of the ADAP transition for the Indigenous dimension specifically: every disabled Indigenous Albertan whose AISH benefit is reduced and who subsequently enters the crisis cascade — emergency department, homeless shelter, provincial custody, child welfare apprehension — costs the Alberta and federal government substantially more in crisis response services than the AISH payment would have cost to continue. The ratio ranges from approximately 1.5-to-1 (emergency department utilization scenario) to 10-to-1 or higher (the full cascade to incarceration and child apprehension scenario). The ADAP transition does not save the Alberta government money. It transfers the cost into other provincial and federal budgets, at a higher per-person total cost, while producing the specific human harms documented in Sections 1 through 14.

The fiscal arithmetic confirms what the moral arithmetic has already established. The transition is not fiscally necessary. It is a policy choice, made against Indigenous consent, against UNDRIP, against the TRC Calls to Action, and against the federal government’s own UNDA Act consistency obligation.

Part 4: What this report asks

Of the Government of Canada

This report asks the Government of Canada to invoke its UNDA Act obligation to ensure that Canadian laws are consistent with UNDRIP. Specifically:

- That the Minister of Crown-Indigenous Relations and Northern Affairs and the Minister of Disability Inclusion formally examine the Alberta AISH-to-ADAP transition for consistency with UNDRIP Articles 19 (consultation), 21(2) (particular attention to persons with disabilities), and 23 (active involvement in developing social programmes), as enacted through the UNDA Act.
- That federal transfer payments and intergovernmental agreements affecting disability supports in Alberta be reviewed for compliance with the same obligations.
- That the HUMA Standing Committee of the House of Commons open a study into the Indigenous dimension of the Alberta ADAP transition, with formal engagement of the Assembly of First Nations, Treaty 6, 7, and 8 confederacies, Métis Settlements General Council, Voice of Albertans with Disabilities, and First Nations disability advocacy organizations.

- That federal Jordan's Principle funding for affected First Nations children be expressly protected against any secondary impact of provincial ADAP changes, including continued access to disability-related products, services, and supports for children of AISH/ADAP recipients.
- That MMIWG2S+ program funding sunset (Section 11) be reversed, with long-term sustained funding provided to the National Family and Survivors Circle, Giganawenimaanaanig, Native Women's Association of Canada, Les Femmes Michif Otipemisiwak, and related organizations — recognizing that the ADAP destabilization cascade feeds the upstream conditions MMIWG2S+ organizations work to interrupt.

Of the Government of Alberta

This report asks the Government of Alberta to:

- Delay the July 1, 2026 ADAP transition implementation until UNDRIP-compliant consultation with Indigenous representative institutions has been completed.
- Publicly disaggregate the Indigenous share of the AISH caseload and commit to transparent reporting on the Indigenous dimension of all ADAP policy outcomes.
- Engage formally with Treaty 6, 7, and 8 confederacies and Métis Settlements General Council on the ADAP framework design, with the goal of obtaining free, prior and informed consent on elements affecting Indigenous Albertans.
- Reverse the dollar-for-dollar clawback of the federal Canada Disability Benefit, which operates against the federal benefit's stated purpose and against the principle that federal disability supports are additive to provincial, not a substitute from which the province withdraws its own.
- Restore independent appeal rights removed by Bill 12, recognizing that the removal of administrative remedy completes a structural exclusion from the policy for which UNDRIP required prior consent.
- Formally acknowledge, in the terms TRC Call to Action 18 directs, that the healthcare rights of Aboriginal people under international law, constitutional law, and the Treaties apply to Alberta provincial policy — not only in acknowledgment statements but in operational implementation including disability policy.

Of Indigenous governance institutions

This report is offered to Indigenous governance institutions not as a request but as documentation. The request direction flows the other way. Specifically:

- The documented patterns in this report are offered as supporting evidence for the assertions and positions that Treaty 6, 7, and 8 confederacies, the Assembly of First Nations, Métis Nation of Alberta, Métis Settlements General Council, and urban Indigenous organizations have already articulated.

- The primary-source research, particularly the specific Alberta administrative coordination documentation in Part 6 of Section 10 and the April 2026 timeliness data in Section 11, is offered as material these institutions may use in advocacy, litigation, international submissions, or coalition-building as they determine.
- The author of this report is non-Indigenous. The report is offered to centre, not replace, Indigenous voices on every matter it documents. Where Indigenous leaders have articulated positions that differ from the framing in this report, those Indigenous articulations are authoritative.

Of federal and provincial opposition parties

This report asks federal and provincial opposition parties — Alberta NDP, federal NDP, federal Liberal Party, federal Bloc Québécois, federal Green Party — to:

- Table the specific findings of this report in relevant committees and question periods.
- Support federal legislative or administrative action requiring the Government of Canada to invoke its UNDA Act consistency obligation in respect of provincial policies affecting Indigenous peoples.
- Support provincial legislative or administrative action delaying the July 1, 2026 ADAP implementation pending consultation.
- Coordinate with Indigenous governance institutions rather than substituting their advocacy for Indigenous-led advocacy.

Of municipal partners and coalition allies

The municipal coalition documented in the Alberta Disability System Breakdown main report series — including Edmonton, Calgary, Lethbridge, Red Deer, Claresholm, Camrose, Medicine Hat, Rocky Mountain House, and growing — is asked to incorporate the Indigenous dimension documented in this report into its advocacy positions. Municipal resolutions on ADAP pause are strengthened by explicit reference to the Indigenous constitutional and UNDRIP dimensions this report documents. The coalition map corresponds to ridings with significant Indigenous populations; the coalition advocacy is stronger when it explicitly includes the Indigenous dimension rather than treating it as a separate file.

Part 5: Closing

This report has been compiled by a non-Indigenous AISH recipient in St. Albert, Alberta, over a period of weeks in the spring of 2026, as part of a broader campaign opposing the July 1, 2026 Alberta Disability Assistance Program transition. The author's own disability eligibility does not make her a representative of the Indigenous population this report documents. It makes her a witness to the administrative apparatus she shares with them, and to the specific features of that apparatus that affect them differently and worse.

The report is offered in the spirit of the covenant that opened it: that everything the author is doing is so that people do not feel alone, or unseen, or unheard. The disabled Indigenous Albertan in April 2026 is not alone. The evidence of their condition is documented in primary sources across federal agencies, provincial ministries, Canadian courts, UN mechanisms, Indigenous governance institutions, and peer-reviewed literature. They have been documented. They have been seen. What has been absent is the translation of documentation into operational remedy.

This report asks for that translation. Not as advocacy, but as compliance with obligations every named actor has already formally accepted. UNDRIP is federal law. The UNDA Act is federal law. The 231 Calls for Justice are federal commitments. The TRC Calls to Action 18 through 24 are federal and provincial commitments. The Canadian Human Rights Tribunal's Jordan's Principle orders are binding. The Treaty relationship predates the province and constrains provincial authority. The constitutional framework of section 35 is non-derogable. The consultation obligation in Kebaowek 2025 is enforceable. The federal court jurisprudence is settled.

The July 1, 2026 ADAP transition proceeds against all of this. The specific ask this report places on every named actor is that the transition not proceed as designed. That it be delayed. That consultation occur. That the federal UNDA Act obligation be invoked. That Treaty 6, 7, and 8 confederacies be engaged as rights-holders and not as stakeholders. That Métis Settlements and urban Indigenous organizations be engaged. That the specific disabled Indigenous Albertan, in April 2026, not be the next unit of documented failure in the pattern this report has traced across fourteen sections.

Disabilities aren't prejudice, and neither am I. We stand together."

The campaign of which this report is part continues through July 1, 2026 and beyond. The report is free to share, free to cite, and free to integrate into any advocacy, legal, or policy submission by any actor named or unnamed in its pages. The primary sources are listed in every section. The specific asks are listed in Part 4 of this section.

What the report does not ask is that the reader agree with every framing the author has chosen. Where Indigenous voices are cited, those voices are authoritative. Where the author's synthesis is offered, it is offered as one non-Indigenous AISH recipient's compilation of primary sources — subject to correction by anyone with better information, and particularly by the Indigenous people whose lives the report documents.

Seventeen sections. One report. One population. One date. Whatever happens on July 1, 2026 and after, the documentation now exists. No one has to start from zero. That is the minimum this report owed the people in it. That is what it has tried to deliver.

—
Compiled and witnessed by

Alberta Disability Breakdown — Advocate

St. Albert, Alberta | April 2026

albertadisabilitybreakdown@outlook.com

End of Section 15

End of the Indigenous Disability Report